

01

## RELIGION AND MORALITY

### CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

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### MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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### CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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Inference: The controversy illustrates the owner's interaction thesis: morality may be shaped by religion, while public moral principles may also criticise religious practices.

### UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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02

## RELIGION AND MORALITY: CORE DISTINCTIONS

### CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Euthyphro dilemma (Plato): Is the pious loved by the gods because it is pious, or pious because it is loved? □ Horn 1 (good because commanded) → morality is arbitrary (God could command cruelty and it'd be "good").

### MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Mnemonic — "Depend / Detach / Dialogue": morality depends on religion (Divine Command), detaches from it (Kant/secular), or dialogues with it (interaction).

### CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Master verdict: Morality is not conceptually reducible to religion, but religion can supply motivation, formation and cosmic significance; morality in turn remains an indispensable internal and external critic of religious life.

### UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Morality without religion is possible — secular ethics (Kant, utilitarianism, humanism) grounds morality in reason/consequences, not God. → the asymmetry.

**ANSWER LINE:** The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.